

# TradesFlow Competitive Analysis

## Positioning Against Field Service Alternatives

### Market Landscape

The field service management software market is crowded, but most solutions are either:

1. **Too generic** — Built for any service business, not trade-specific
2. **Too complex** — Enterprise features that solo techs don't need
3. **Too expensive** — Per-user pricing that penalizes growth

TradesFlow occupies a unique position: **purpose-built for trades, simple enough for solo operators, powerful enough for teams.**

### Competitor Overview

| Platform       | Target Market       | Key Strength       | Key Weakness               |
|----------------|---------------------|--------------------|----------------------------|
| ServiceTitan   | Large HVAC/Plumbing | Comprehensive      | Expensive, complex         |
| Housecall Pro  | Home services       | Marketing features | Per-user fees, generic     |
| Jobber         | Small field service | Clean UI           | Limited equipment tracking |
| FieldEdge      | HVAC/Plumbing       | QuickBooks sync    | Dated interface            |
| Service Fusion | Mid-market          | Fleet tracking     | Complex setup              |
| mHelpDesk      | Small business      | Simplicity         | Limited features           |

### Feature Comparison Matrix

| Feature              | TradesFlow | ServiceTitan | Housecall Pro | Jobber  | FieldEdge |
|----------------------|------------|--------------|---------------|---------|-----------|
| Core Features        |            |              |               |         |           |
| Customer CRM         | ✓          | ✓            | ✓             | ✓       | ✓         |
| Scheduling           | ✓          | ✓            | ✓             | ✓       | ✓         |
| Invoicing            | ✓          | ✓            | ✓             | ✓       | ✓         |
| Mobile App           | ✓          | ✓            | ✓             | ✓       | ✓         |
| Differentiators      |            |              |               |         |           |
| Equipment Passport™  | ✓          | Limited      | ×             | ×       | Limited   |
| Full Service History | ✓          | ✓            | Limited       | Limited | ✓         |
| Photo Documentation  | ✓          | ✓            | ✓             | ✓       | ×         |
| Warranty Tracking    | ✓          | ✓            | ×             | ×       | ×         |
| Notifications        |            |              |               |         |           |
| SMS Included         | ✓          | Add-on       | Limited       | Add-on  | Add-on    |

|                      |         |           |         |         |           |
|----------------------|---------|-----------|---------|---------|-----------|
| Email                | ✓       | ✓         | ✓       | ✓       | ✓         |
| Automated Reminders  | ✓       | ✓         | ✓       | ✓       | ✓         |
| <b>Pricing Model</b> |         |           |         |         |           |
| Per-User Fees        | ×       | Yes       | Yes     | Yes     | Yes       |
| Contract Required    | ×       | Yes       | ×       | ×       | Yes       |
| Free Trial           | 14 days | Demo only | 14 days | 14 days | Demo only |

## Pricing Comparison

### Monthly Cost by Team Size

| Team Size | TradesFlow   | ServiceTitan | Housecall Pro | Jobber |
|-----------|--------------|--------------|---------------|--------|
| 1 user    | <b>\$29</b>  | \$125+       | \$65+         | \$49+  |
| 3 users   | <b>\$79</b>  | \$375+       | \$165+        | \$129+ |
| 5 users   | <b>\$79</b>  | \$398+       | \$199+        | \$249+ |
| 10 users  | <b>\$199</b> | \$796+       | \$399+        | \$449+ |
| 20 users  | <b>\$199</b> | \$1,592+     | \$799+        | \$899+ |

*TradesFlow pricing reflects our no-per-user-fee model for Professional tier*

### Annual Cost Comparison (5 Users)

|                          |              |                                   |
|--------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------|
| TradesFlow Professional: | \$948/year   | <div><div></div><div></div></div> |
| Jobber:                  | \$2,988/year | <div><div></div><div></div></div> |
| Housecall Pro:           | \$2,388/year | <div><div></div><div></div></div> |
| ServiceTitan:            | \$4,776/year | <div><div></div><div></div></div> |

**TradesFlow saves \$1,440 - \$3,828 annually compared to alternatives.**

## TradesFlow Advantages

### 1. Equipment Passport™ — Unique to TradesFlow

No other platform offers comprehensive equipment tracking with:

- Full specifications (brand, model, serial, install date)
- Warranty expiration tracking
- Photo documentation
- Complete service history per equipment

**Impact:** Customers remember you as the expert who "knows their equipment."

### 2. Trade-Specific Design

Built for:

- HVAC technicians
- Plumbers
- Electricians

- Roofers
- Appliance repair professionals

Not generic "home services" — real trade workflows.

### 3. Simplicity Without Sacrifice

| Others                        | TradesFlow                 |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 50+ features you'll never use | Features you actually need |
| 2-week implementation         | 5-minute setup             |
| Training required             | Intuitive interface        |
| Feature bloat                 | Focused functionality      |

### 4. Fair Pricing Model

| Others                | TradesFlow                   |
|-----------------------|------------------------------|
| Per-user fees         | Unlimited users (Enterprise) |
| Annual contracts      | Month-to-month               |
| Hidden add-ons        | Transparent pricing          |
| "Contact for pricing" | Prices on website            |

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## TradesFlow Gaps (Honest Assessment)

We believe in transparency. Here's where we're still building:

| Gap                     | Status  | Timeline |
|-------------------------|---------|----------|
| Online customer booking | Planned | Q2 2026  |
| Integrated payments     | Planned | Q2 2026  |
| QuickBooks sync         | Planned | Q3 2026  |
| Marketing automation    | Planned | Q4 2026  |
| Multi-location support  | Planned | Q4 2026  |
| Vendor integrations     | Planned | 2027     |
| Inventory management    | Planned | 2027     |

**Mitigation:** See our Roadmap document for our development cadence and commitments.

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## Ideal Customer Profile

### Best Fit for TradesFlow

#### Company Size:

- Solo technicians to 50+ employee companies
- Especially strong for 1-20 technician operations

**Trade Types:**

- HVAC contractors
- Plumbing companies
- Electrical contractors
- Roofing businesses
- Appliance repair services

**Business Stage:**

- Growing businesses ready to professionalize
- Companies outgrowing spreadsheets and paper
- Teams frustrated with per-user pricing

**Characteristics:**

- Value simplicity over feature bloat
- Want equipment tracking and history
- Prefer transparent, predictable pricing
- Need mobile access for field staff

**Less Ideal Fit**

- Very large enterprises (500+ technicians) — consider ServiceTitan
- Businesses needing complex inventory management — we're building this
- Companies requiring extensive third-party integrations today — we're expanding

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## Competitive Response Guide

**When They Say...****"ServiceTitan has more features"**

*"You're right — they're great for enterprises. But do you need 50 features you'll never use? TradesFlow has everything you need, nothing you don't. And at 1/4 the cost."*

**"Housecall Pro is cheaper for 1 user"**

*"For 1 user, maybe. But what happens when you grow? Our Professional tier includes 5 users for one price. Plus, you get the Equipment Passport — a feature they don't have at any price."*

**"Jobber has been around longer"**

*"Experience matters. But so does focus. We're built specifically for trades, with features like equipment tracking that matter to your business. Try our free trial and judge for yourself."*

**"Why haven't I heard of TradesFlow?"**

*"We're growing through word-of-mouth from happy customers, not massive marketing budgets. Our 4.9/5 rating comes from focusing on what matters: helping trade businesses succeed."*

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## Summary Positioning

For trade businesses who want professional-grade field service management without enterprise complexity or pricing, TradesFlow is the platform that offers the unique Equipment Passport™ feature, trade-specific workflows, and fair, transparent pricing.

Unlike competitors who charge per user and offer generic home services tools, we provide unlimited users (Enterprise), focus exclusively on trades, and deliver the equipment tracking that builds customer trust.

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*For detailed feature documentation, see the Product Guide. For transparent assessment of our current limitations, see the Adversarial Audit.*